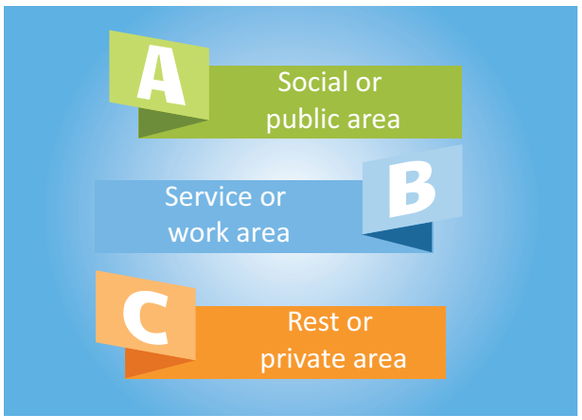
5.3.1 Effective Space Allocation in a House

The house and its grounds can be divided into three major areas based on the various activities of the house.



Division of major areas in the house

1) **Social or public area** - The rooms allotted are, veranda, living room, reception, dining, music, reception and games room.
2) **Service or work area** - The rooms allotted are kitchen, serving, laundry, drying yard, ironing room, garage, storage areas, office and study room.
3) **Rest or private area** - Bedroom, dressing room, bathrooms, prayer room etc. It is not possible to allot room for each and every activity separately, but it is important to allot spaces for the more important ones.

5.3.2 Rooms in the House

The rooms in the house and various activities carried out there are discussed in the following paragraphs:

A veranda serves many purposes. It is a place for stranger or a visitor to wait. It is a place for keeping shoes, walking sticks, umbrellas and a place to store vehicles. It provides place for business, the postman, the newspaper boy, milkman, and the vendors to call on the family members at the entrance. It serves as a passage to other rooms of the house. It protects the walls of the house from the direct rays of the sun. It is a place for pets and also a place for growing plants.

The Back Veranda/ Balcony

It serves different functions such as grinding, drying clothes etc. A veranda/ balcony facing south or west is comfortable.

Living Room

Living room is placed adjacent to veranda. The living room should provide place for many of the family activities as reading, conversation, get together, indoor games and light music. It is a place to receive friends and also to hold social functions. In a small house, it can serve as a study room for children, sleeping area for one or two members. It can be a dining room during special occasions. At times it can accommodate guests. Thus it may serve multi various functions, depending upon the type of the family. A living room should express cordial welcome to the friends of the family. The furniture and furnishing that are used in the living room must be comfortable and suitable for the room. **For example**,

Conversation	-	Sofa, chairs
Hospitality	-	Centre coffee table
Reading	-	Table, chairs and bookcase
Recreation	-	Radio and television cabinet, table and chairs

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